Sharing qualitative research data

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EUR Data Coffee Breaks
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Presentation:
Joanna Mania, Eduard Klapwijk

Erasmus University Rotterdam

EUR Data Coffee Breaks

- Monthly meetings organized by the EUR Data Stewards
- Short, focused, and informal
- 15-minute presentations
- Twice a month (online)
- No recordings, slides available on EUR Data Stewardship (Zenodo)

Sharing qualitative research data

1. What is qualitative data?
2. What are the benefits of sharing?
3. Concerns
4. Frameworks
5. What to publish and what to archive?
6. Practical takeaways

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What is qualitative data?

Data type: non-numeric
Data collection: interviews, focus groups, observations of communities or individuals, archival materials, websites
Analysis: coding
Goal: understanding unique context, meaning, building a theory, explore study topic
Role of participants: determine response categories

References for qualitative data definitions:
DuBois et al. (2017) and Alexander et al. (2020)

Photo by charlesdeluvio on Unsplash

What are benefits of sharing qualitative data?

Researcher

Trustworthiness
New perspective

Participant

Decrease burden on underrepresented participants

Funder

Fostering public trust
Return of investment

References for qualitative data benefits: DuBois et al. (2017) and Alexander et al. (2020)

Addressing concerns of sharing qualitative data

Subjectivity and context

-> gain other perspective
-> transcripts > quotes
-> provide additional materials

Personal data

-> informed consent
-> anonymization
-> access restrictions

Confidentiality and harms

-> do not share, if risk of serious harm
-> participants' willingness to share data

Reference for challenges and responses: DuBois et al. (2017)

Addressing concerns of sharing qualitative data

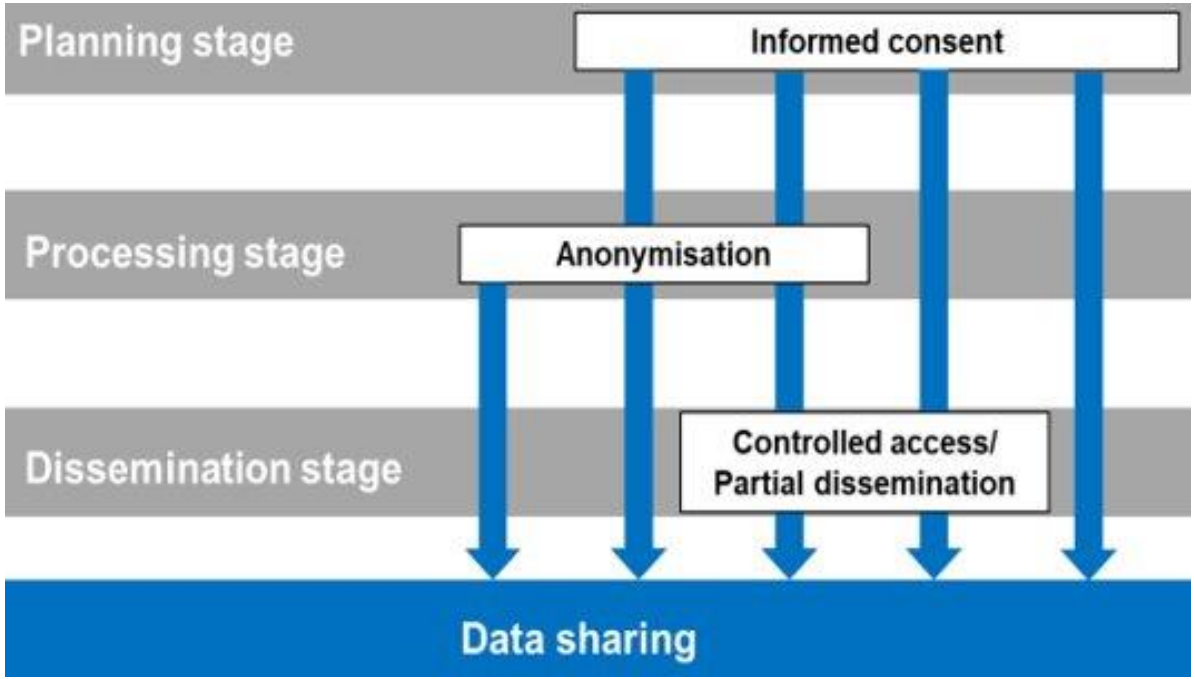


Image: forscenter.ch

- ask for consent and specify what data will be shared, where and for how long

- choose scheme carefully
- sharing > not sharing
- budget it in advance

- restricted access with conditions (ethics approval, training, upon request, registered user of repository)

Reference for challenges and responses: DuBois et al. (2017)

Framework: level of access and processing when sharing

Level of data processing

Level of access	Raw	Redacted	Summarized
Open publicly available			
Restricted Available if meets standard criteria			
Controlled Approved case-by-case			
Closed Institutional Archive			

Framework for qualitative data access and processing levels adapted from Jones et al. (2018) and Alexander et al. (2020)

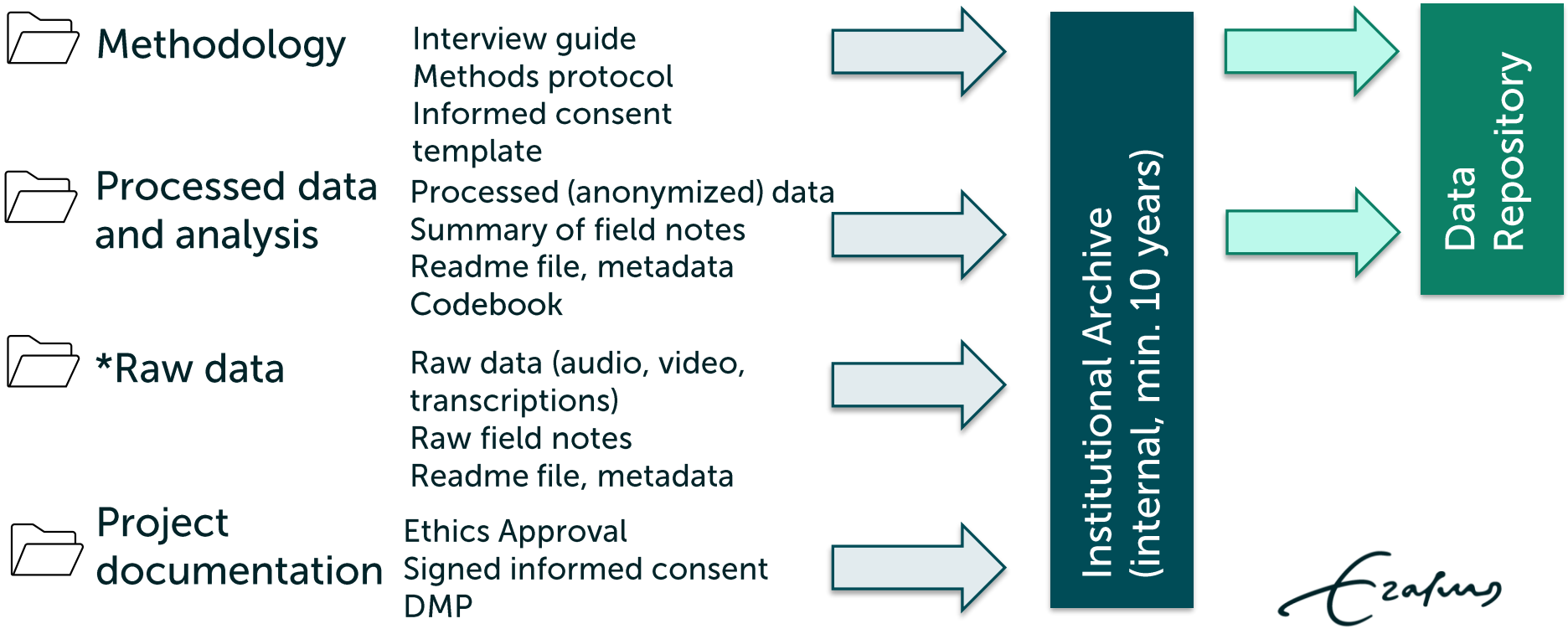
Framework: examples

Level of data processing

Level of access	Raw data	Redacted	Summarized
Open publicly available	*interview questionnaire*		*summary of thematic analysis of interview transcripts*
Restricted Available if meets standard criteria		*thematic coding of focus group transcripts*	
Controlled Approved case-by-case			
Closed Institutional Archive	*photographs of faces, interview videos*		

Framework for qualitative data access and processing levels adapted from Jones et al. (2018) and Alexander et al. (2020)

What to publish and what to archive?



Practical takeaways

Before:

- Consider legal abd ethical implications
- Include costs in budget (e.g., anonymization, data documentation)

Preparation:

- Informed consent forms
- Data management plan
- Identify data repository

During:

- Proper data documentation, organization and metadata
- Anonymize carefully

Towards end:

- Prepare your data for archiving and re-use
- Choose proper access level

Questions

Thank you!

Coming up:

January: **Do’s and Don’ts for DMPs**
February: **Intro to versioning (and git)**
March: **How to choose a repository?**

See schedule for more information

Do you have suggestion for a topic?
Contact us via EUR Research Data Stewards

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